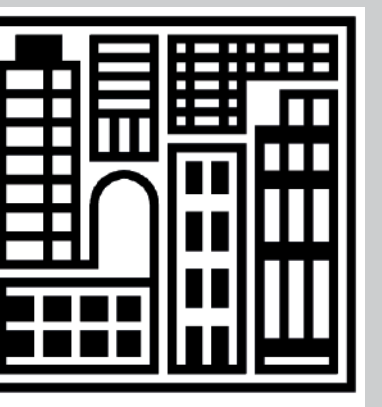


| KYPSELI SUPERBLOCK |

A Multi-Scale Vision for Climate Adaptation, Social Inclusion & Urban Livability in Athens

Urban Futures Symposium 2025
Dübendorf, September 01 – 02, 2025



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1 KYPSELI, ATHENS' CONTEXT



ATHENS IS UNDERGOING PROFOUND URBAN AND ENVIRONMENTAL PRESSURES, EXACERBATED BY CLIMATE CHANGE AND SOCIO-SPATIAL FRAGMENTATION.



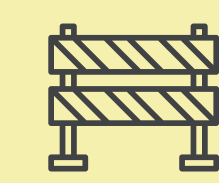
Urban & Environmental Challenges

- Urban heat island: +3.5°C, temps >40°C
- Water scarcity & Outdated infrastructure
- Minimal green space: 2–2.5 m² per resident (WHO standard: 9 m²)
- Aging buildings, poor insulation
- Car-dominated streets: noise and air pollution
- Soil Impermeability



Social & Spatial Dynamics

- Multicultural vibrancy but rising gentrification, overcrowding, rents
- Persistent socio-spatial fragmentation



Barriers to Change

- **Top-down:** lack of political will, limited funding, rigid planning
- **Bottom-up:** fragmented ownership, low incentives, car-centric habits, heterogeneity

2 SUPERBLOCKS FOR KYPSELI

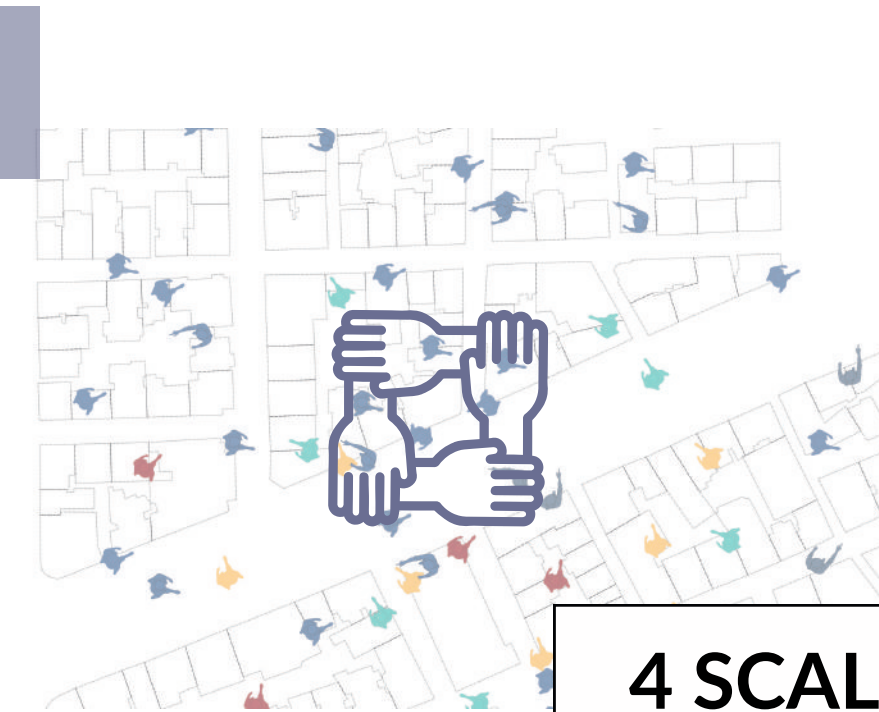


KYPSELI, one of Athens' densest neighbourhoods, is an epicenter of social, spatial, and environmental tensions, where issues of climate resilience, equity, and inclusive regeneration converge and urgently call for a coordinated multi-scalar intervention.



Community

Social dynamics
Local perspectives
Participation



Streets

Mobility
Greenery
Livability



4 SCALES OF INTERVENTION

Courtyards

Social activation
Thermal comfort
Biodiversity



Buildings

Adaptive reuse
Retrofits
Social Activation



3 METHODOLOGY

Interdisciplinary Workshop

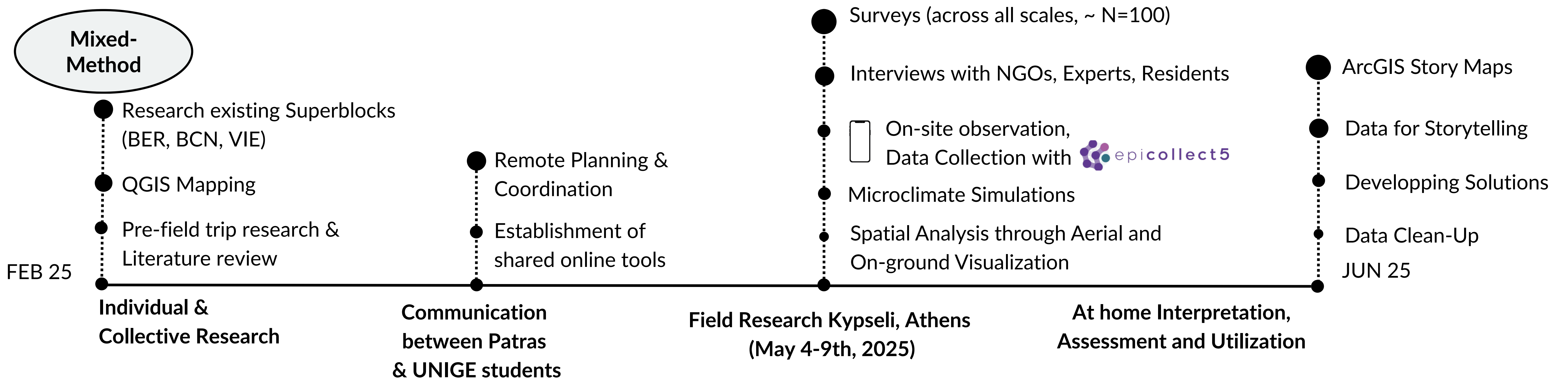


Social Science



Architecture

GOAL: Develop an evidence-based, locally grounded strategy to tackle major urban challenges while reflecting the needs of the community through a participatory planning process.

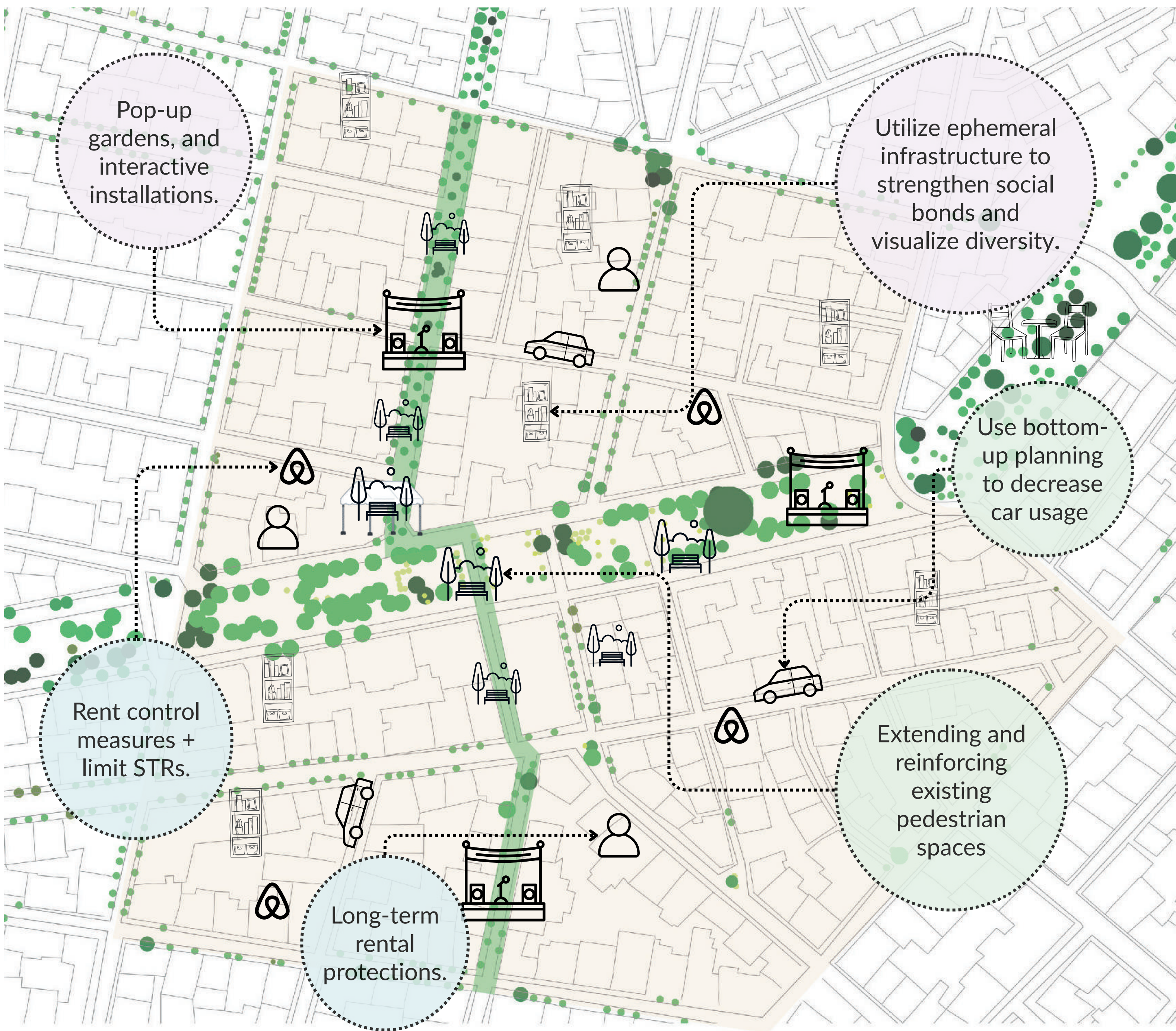


4 RESULTS

COMMUNITY

FINDINGS

- Rising social tensions and mixed perceptions of diversity
- High demand for green/public spaces vs. limited parking
- Gentrification, rising rents, STRs, displacement



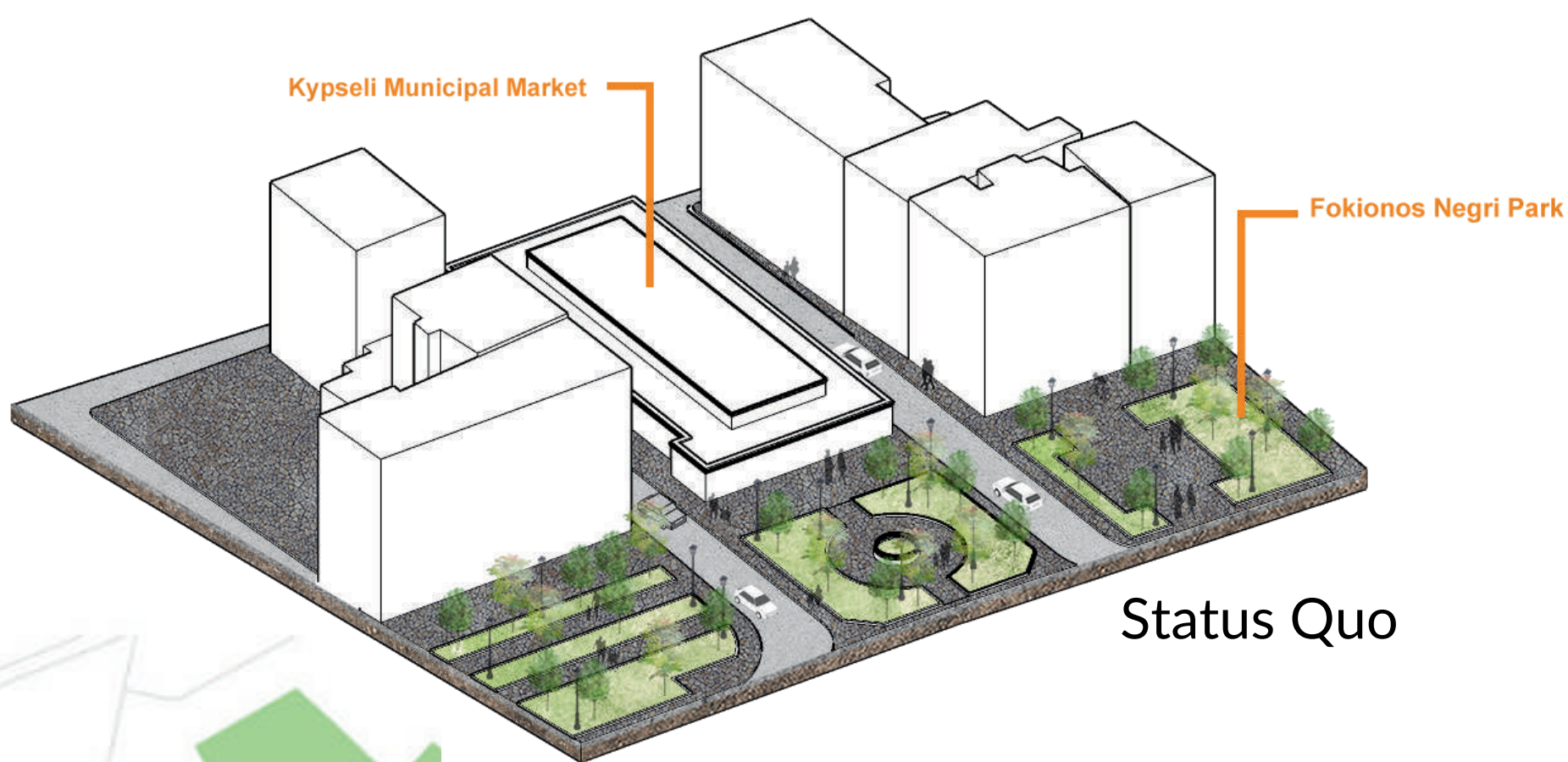
Full analysis here

ACTS

STREETS

Key Problems / Findings

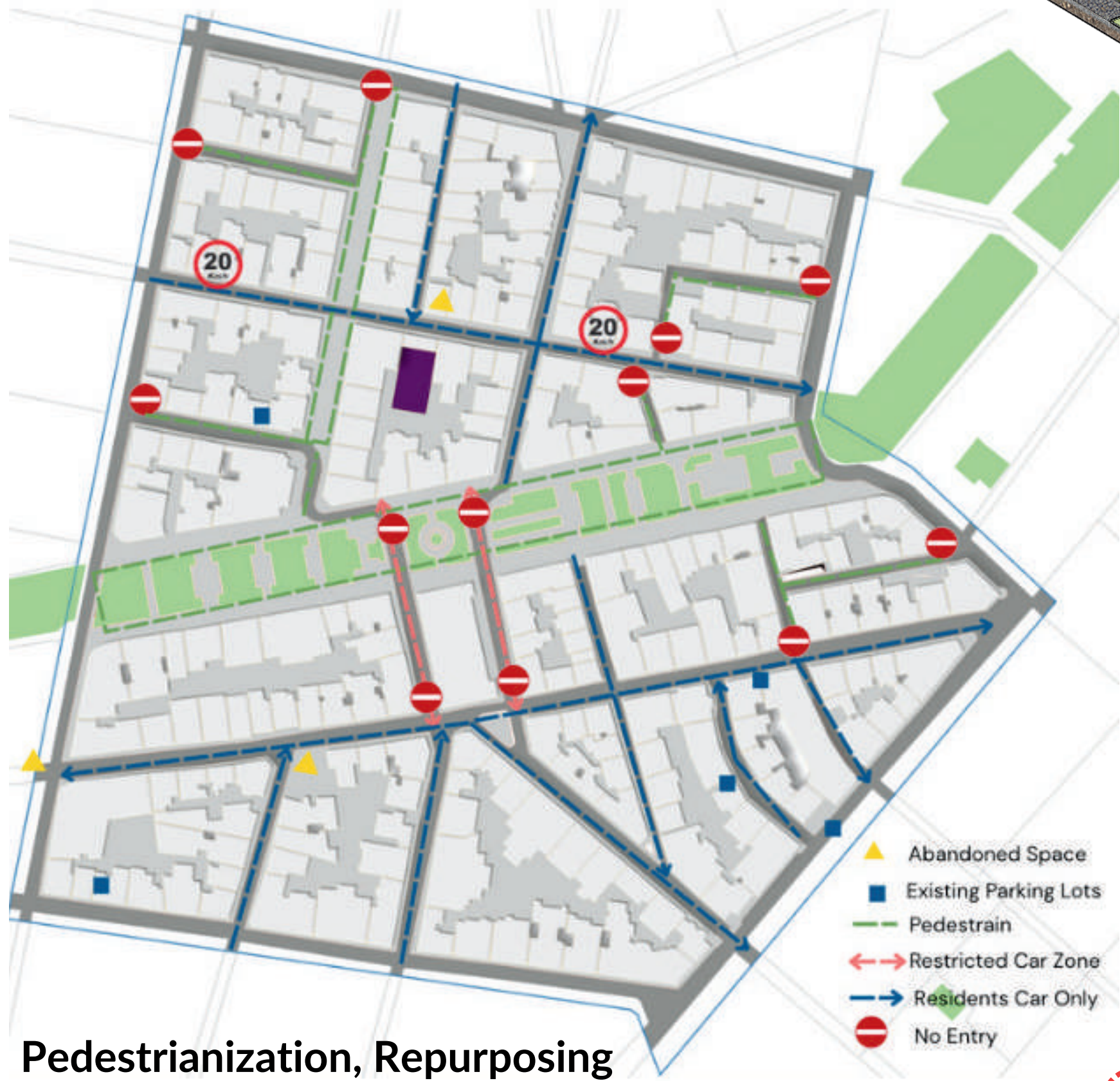
- Heavy car circulation limits pedestrian safety
- Lack of shaded seating areas despite high foot traffic
- Street edges dominated by parking → little social use
- Weak connectivity between the Market and Fokionos Negri promenade



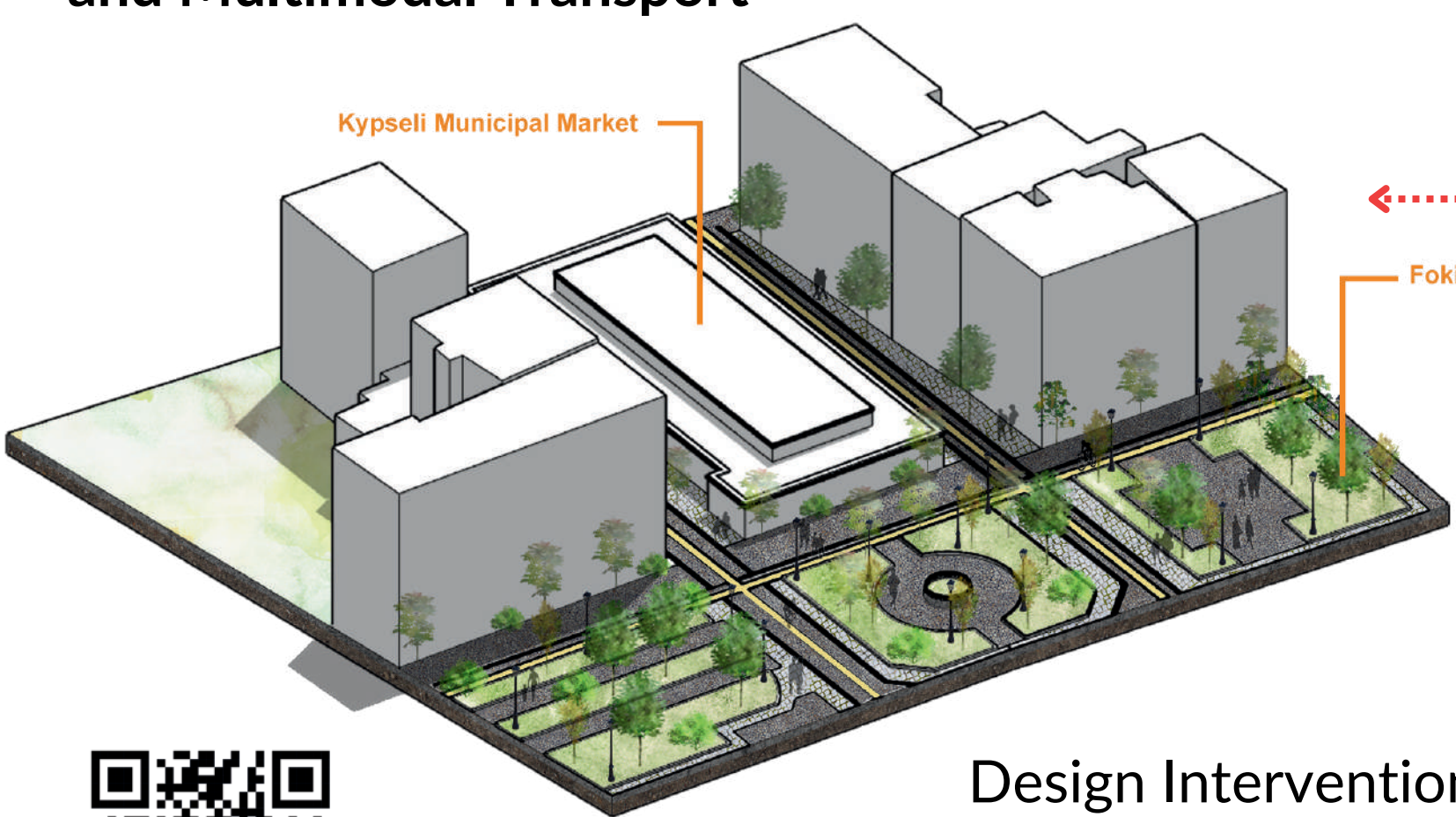
Status Quo

Proposed ACTS

- Decrease car usage with superblock circulation plan
- Extend pedestrianized & shaded streets
- Reinforce cycling lanes
- Enhance urban biodiversity with green corridors



Pedestrianization, Repurposing and Multimodal Transport



Design Intervention



Full analysis here



Zone Visualization



COURTYARDS - AKALYPTOS

FINDINGS

Varying levels of openness, care commitment, expertise and resources



THE AKALYPTOS SOLUTION



transformation plan (by function)

- Residential
- Commercial
- Park
- Cultural

CREATE shared communal areas for social interaction and relaxation

INTEGRATE community-based businesses that embrace local creative values

MAXIMIZE environmental benefits, contributing to biodiversity efforts

DEVELOP community hubs for neighborhood events and activities

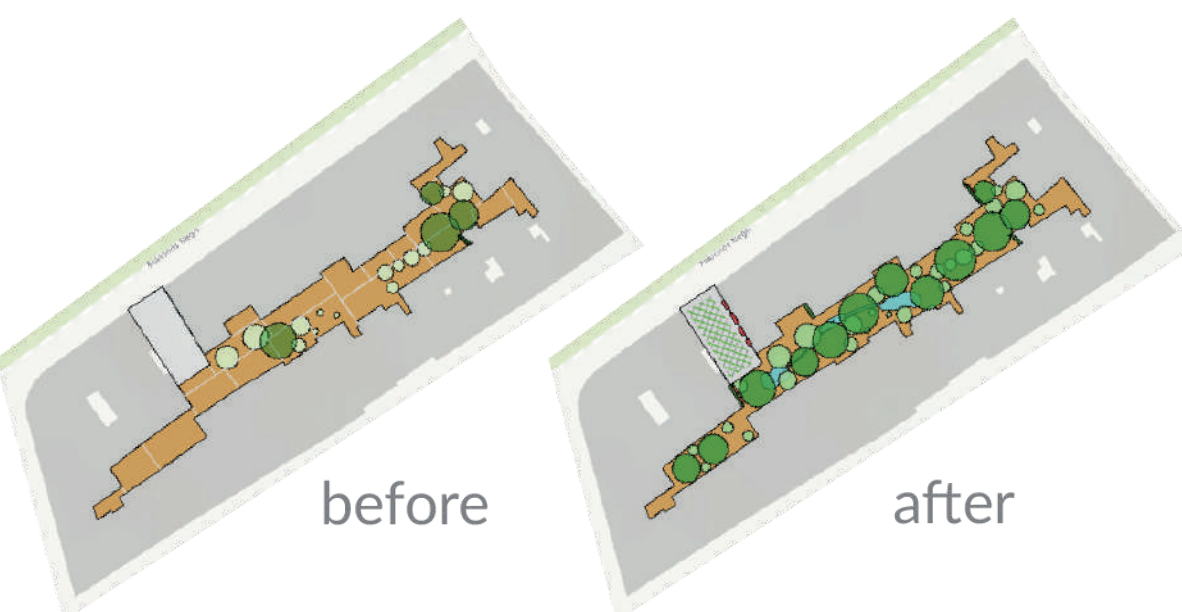
transformation pillars

1. **GOVERNANCE:** regulate, incentivize, mobilize, educate and manage

2. **SOCIAL:** building trust and collective capacity within existing structure

3. **ENVIRONMENTAL:** scaling climate-resilient and biodiverse sanctuaries

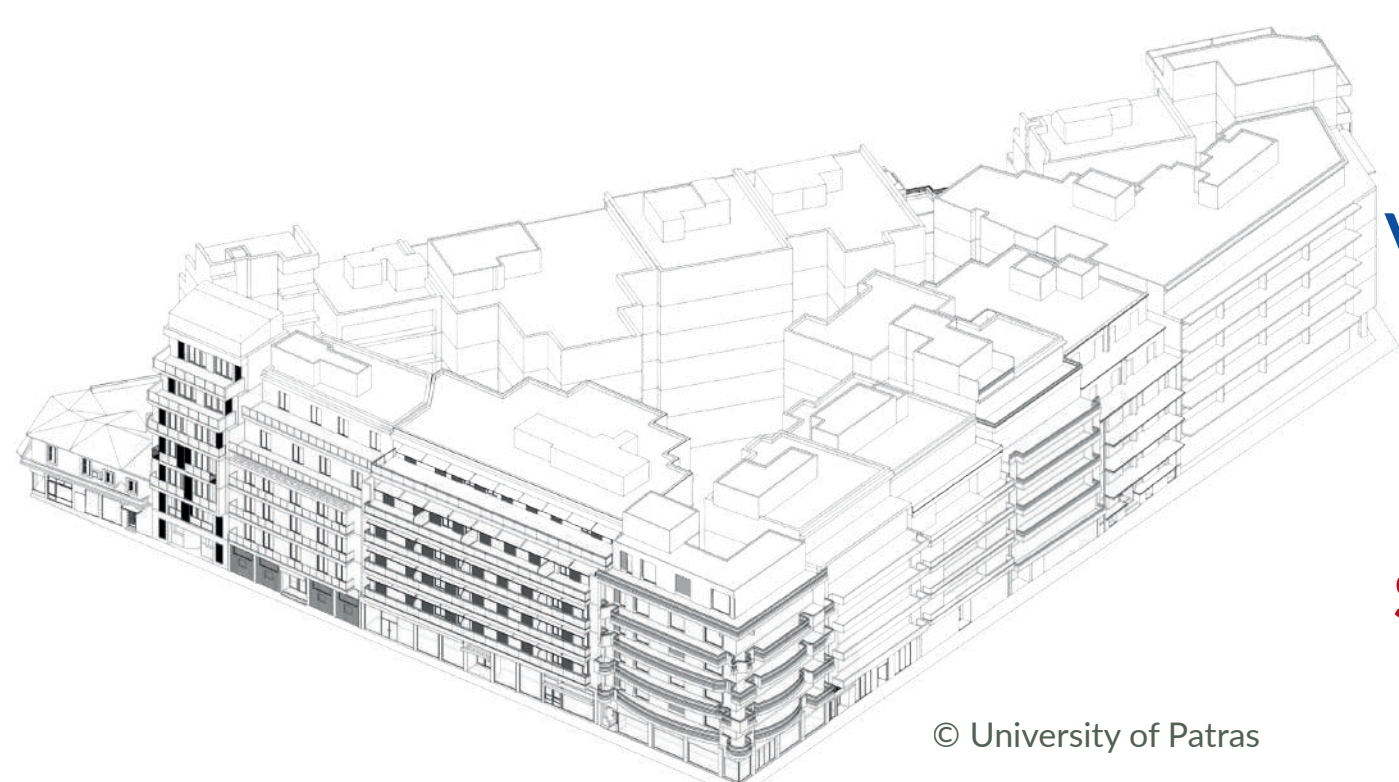
- Birdhouses
- Green rooftop
- Greenwall
- Low building gap
- Trees canopy overstory
- Trees canopy understory
- Water feature



Full analysis here

BUILDINGS - POLYKATOIKIA

FACTS



© University of Patras

SKIN

Aging Structure
Heat Exposure
Limited Greenery

VEINS

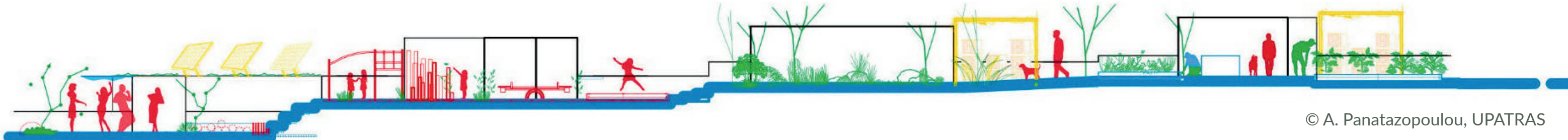
Inaccessibility
Rooftop/Balcony Underusage
Energy Inefficiency

SOUL

Vertical Segregation
Unused Communal Spaces
Ownership Challenges
Privacy Gaps



ACTS



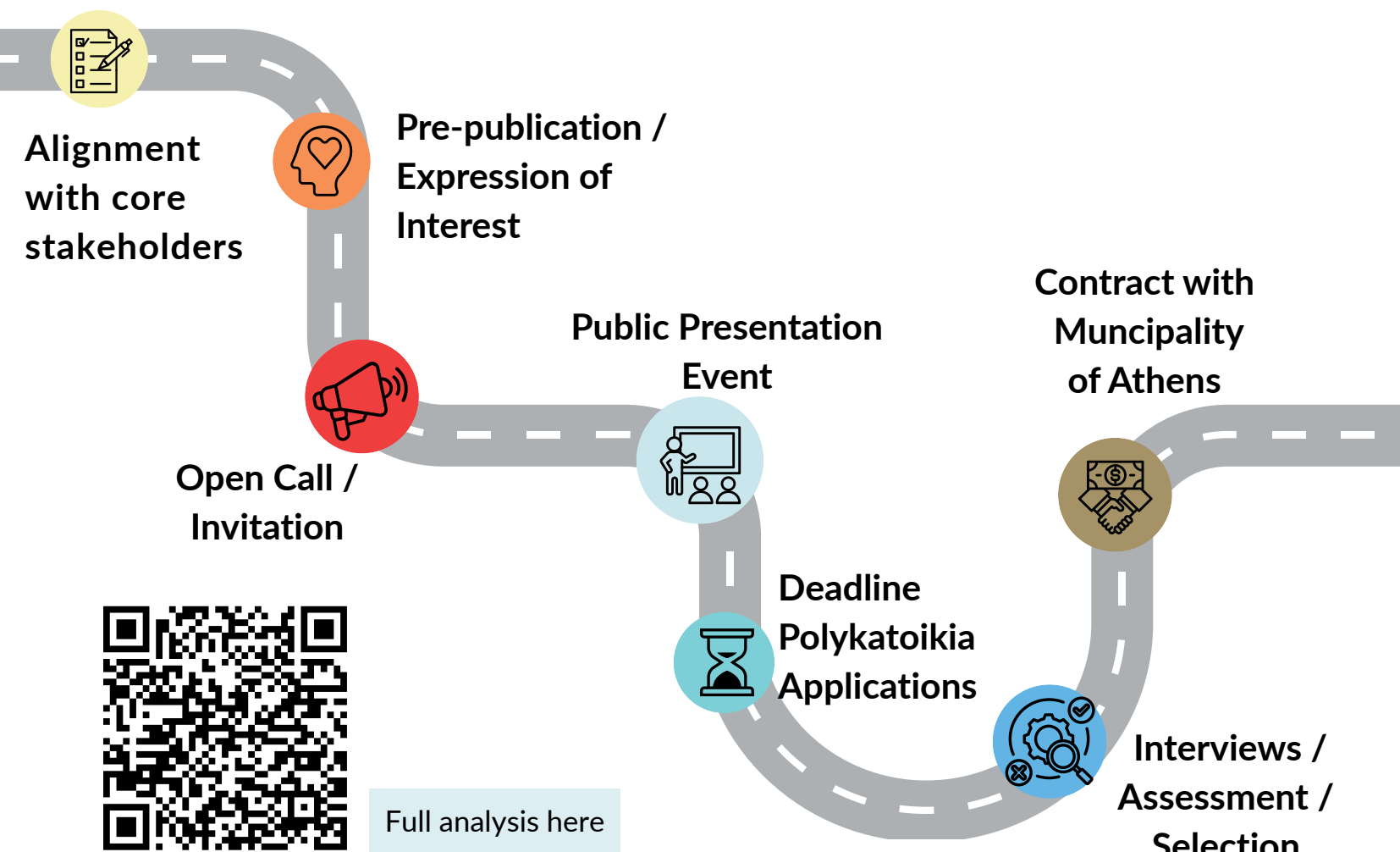
© A. Panatatzopoulou, UPATRAS



2ND SKIN

A demokatoikia co-planned, co-designed, and co-managed by its residents.

DEMOKATOIKIA



PHASE 1: Launch & Engagement Process
Mobilizing residents, select polykatoikias

PHASE 2: Participatory Design & Action Plans
Creating tailored interventions with local organisations & community

PHASE 3: Implementation of Interventions
Transforming polykatoikias with residents & experts

PHASE 4: Fulfillment - Co-Management & Monitoring
Residents co-manage interventions for long-term impact

PHASE 5: From Pilot to Scalable Model
Kypseli Superblock pilot informs urban policy & regeneration

